

# Theming Fix — Green Links Across All Sub-sites

2026-09-27 · branch `content-type-styling-plan` (after 70f3667) · follows `plans/content-type-styling.md` Phase 2/5 method · **uncommitted** — awaiting review

**Issue.** Links across every sub-site render in the LP lime green (  #4AC728 ) instead of the site's link colour — visible in the previous run's report (bobscapes listing headlines, gis-planning full-view headlines and file names, table author links, portlet navigation, "Manage portlets", footer links).

## 1. Analysis — what the live site does

Following the plan's Phase 2 method (extract live rules, then measure computed values), the live link colour turns out to be **the same on all 15 sub-sites**; it is not a per-theme token at all:

| Source                                                                       | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Plone 4 <code>base.css</code> (site-wide)                                    | <code>a:link, a:visited { color: #205c90 } · #content a:link, dl.portlet a:link { color: #205c90; border-bottom: .1em solid #ccc } · #content a:visited { color: #427597 } · #content a:hover { color: #75ad0a !important }</code>                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <code>ploneCustom.css</code> (site-wide)                                     | <code>a:visited { color: #205C90 !important } · #content a:link { border-bottom: none }</code>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Computed on dev, 1440, content-area probe link, every sub-site root + anchor |  <code>rgb(32,92,144) = #205c90</code> , <code>text-decoration: none</code> , no border — identical on all 15 (the-literature-gateway's sample link was yellow because that page's element has its own rule; its probe link is still #205c90). Hover →  <code>#75ad0a</code> . |

**Local before.** Every theme computed `--bs-link-color: #4AC728` and content links `rgb(74,199,40)` on 14 of 15 sub-sites (lp-parent's first content link happened to be body-coloured). Only **anchor** had overridden it (`--bs-link-color: #205C90 + #content a`), and the-literature-gateway has its own `#content a:link`.

**Root cause.** `_shared/scss/_variables.scss` sets `$primary: #4AC728` (the LP lime used for the published-state colour and primary buttons). Bootstrap defaults `$link-color: $primary`, so with no `$link-color` override every Bootstrap/Barceloneta link consumer — `--bs-link-color`, reboot's `a`, portlet nav, breadcrumbs (already patched individually in `_base.scss`), pagination, footer — inherited the green. The breadcrumb comment in `_base.scss` had already noted this ("*links inherit --bs-link-color which is set to the LP lime-green primary — distracting*") but only fixed breadcrumbs.

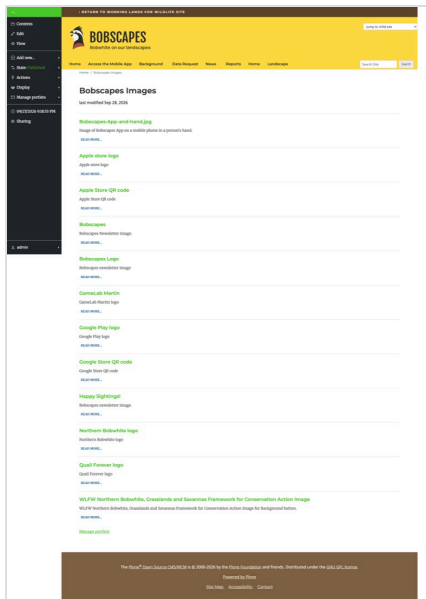
**Decision ladder:** identical on all sub-sites → **Layer 1**, one shared change; no per-theme code. Per-theme rules that already set a different colour on specific elements (nav, portlet headers, lit-gateway's yellow links) are untouched because they are more specific or load later.

## 2. Change (shared Layer 1, 2 files)

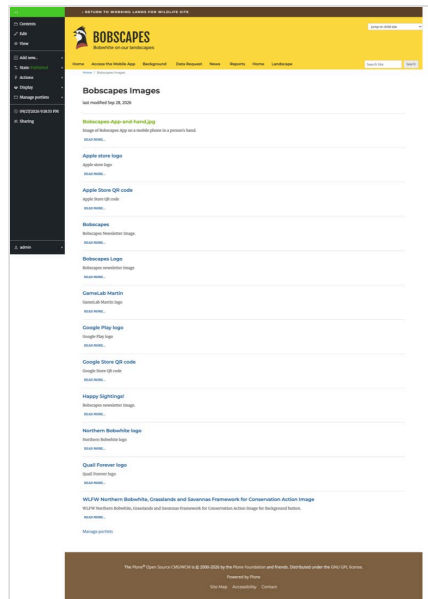
| File                                                | Change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>themes/_shared/scss/_variables.scss</code>    | Added, before <code>bootstrap/scss/variables</code> is imported: <code>\$link-color: #205c90; \$link-hover-color: #75ad0a; \$link-decoration: none; \$link-hover-decoration: none;</code> (commented with the live evidence). <code>\$primary</code> is deliberately unchanged — it still drives the published-state colour and <code>.btn-primary</code> , which are not part of this issue. |
| <code>themes/_shared/scss/_base.scss</code>         | Guard for the <b>stock Barceloneta footer</b> : <code>#portal-footer-wrapper a { color: inherit; text-decoration: underline (35% white) }</code> . See §4 — without it the four themes that never set a footer link colour would show dark-blue links on a dark band.                                                                                                                         |
| <code>themes/*/styles/theme.min.css</code> (+ maps) | Recompiled by the watcher; <code>--bs-link-color:#205c90</code> confirmed in all 15 minified builds, no <code>#4AC728</code> link colour left.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

### 3. Verification (Phase 5)

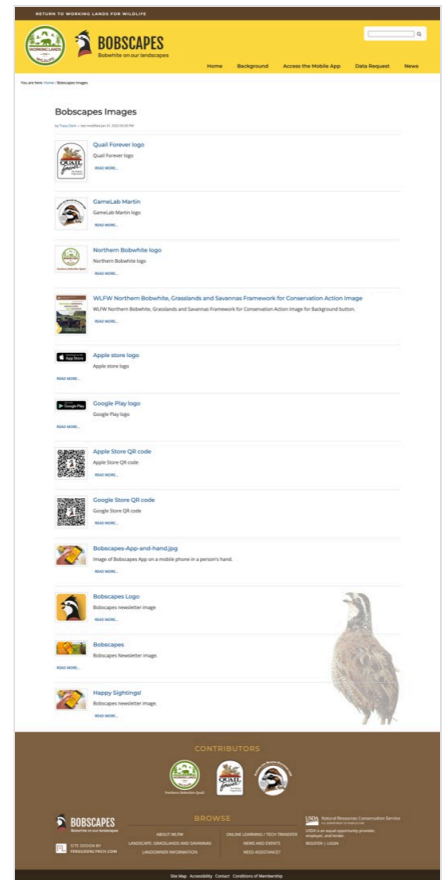
Local, logged in at 1660, on one page per sub-site (roots plus the listing pages from the previous report). Computed content-area probe link on **all 15**: `rgb(32,92,144)`, `text-decoration: none`, `--bs-link-color: #205c90`. Hover on a bobscapes listing headline: `rgb(32,92,144) → rgb(117,173,10)` (= live #75ad0a). Headline links that a theme colours deliberately keep their colour (grasslands Merriweather blue-grey, lit-gateway). Chrome unaffected: header nav, portlet headers, breadcrumbs and buttons compute the same colours as before (before/after full-page captures below are pixel-identical outside link text).



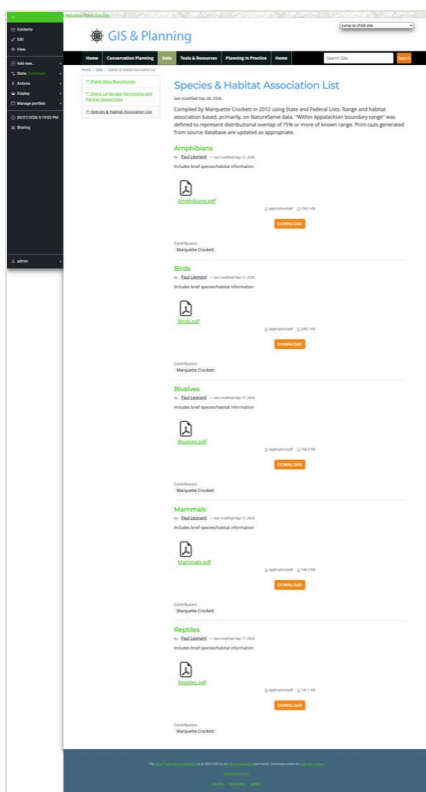
bobscapes summary listing — BEFORE this fix (green headlines, green "Manage portlets")



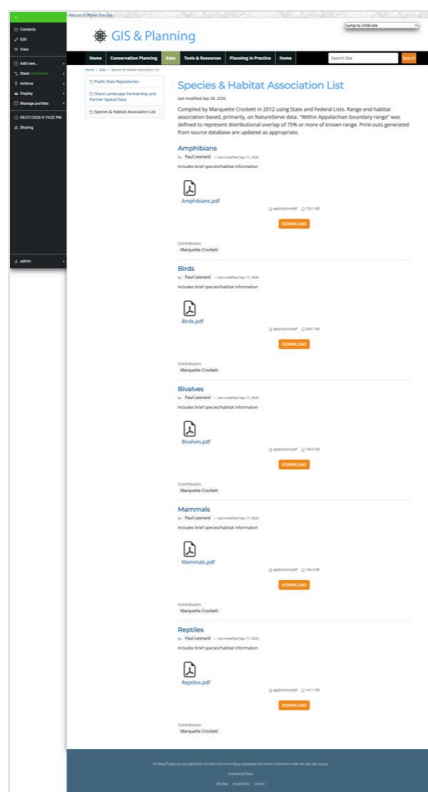
AFTER — #205c90 (first headline is mid-hover: #75ad0a)



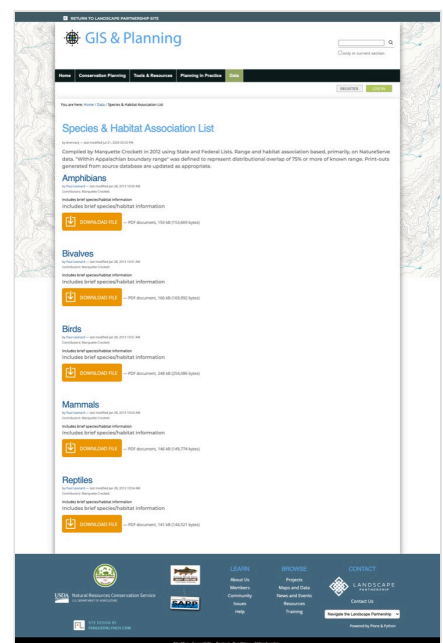
LIVE (dev 1440)



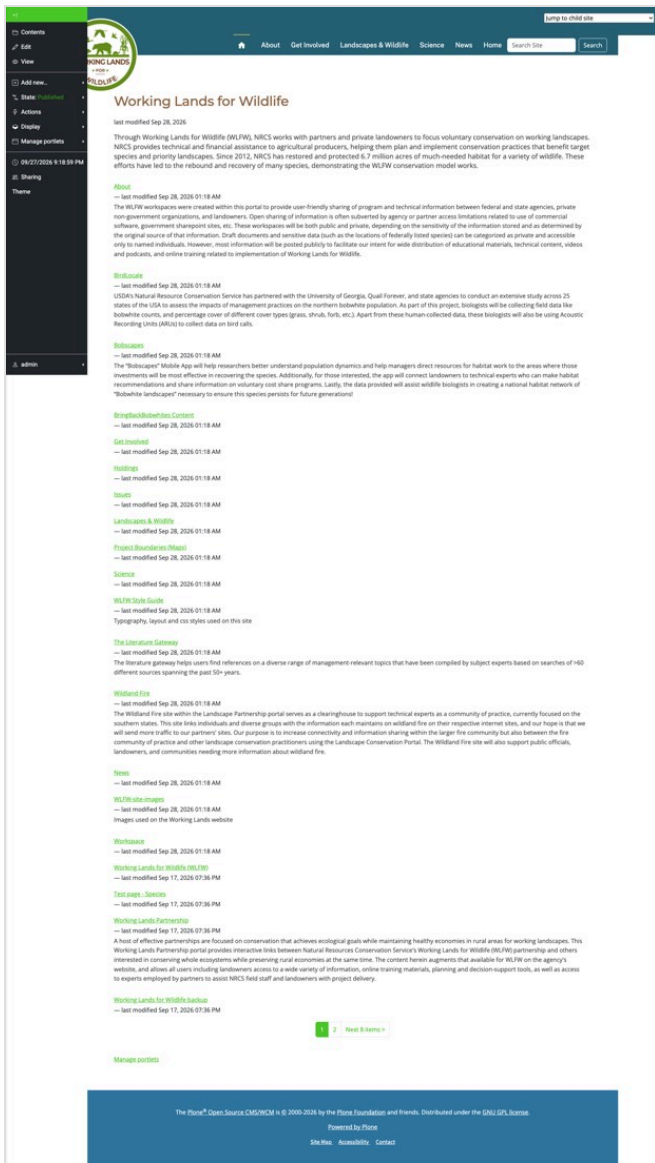
gis-planning full view — BEFORE (green headlines, file names, portlet nav)



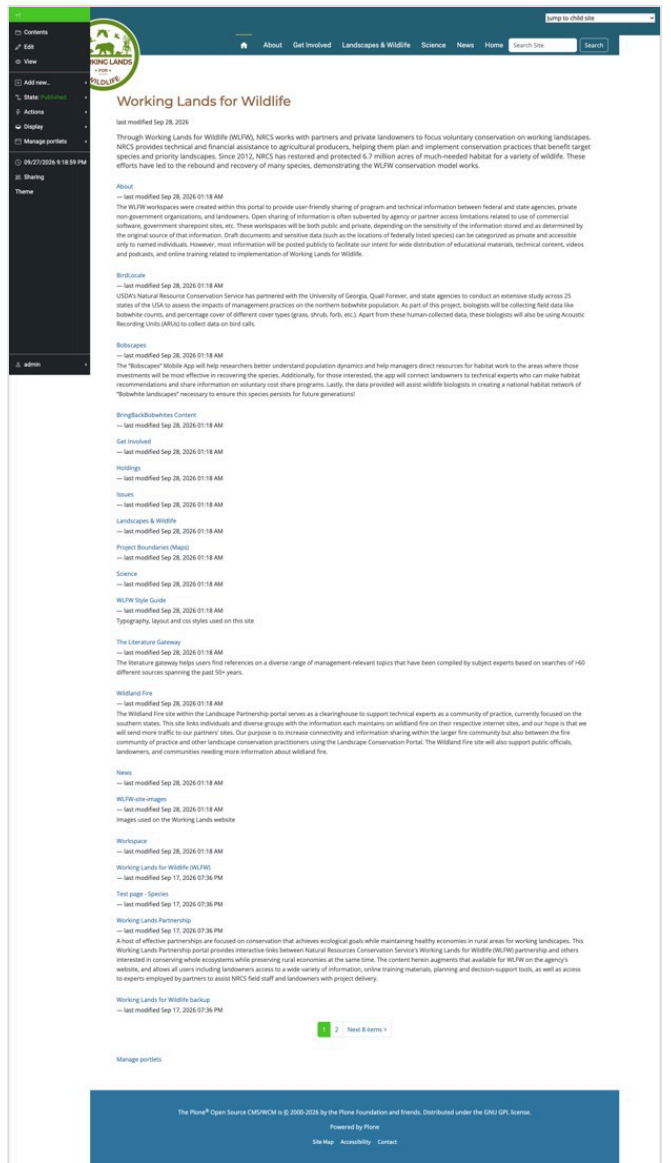
AFTER (footer guard included)



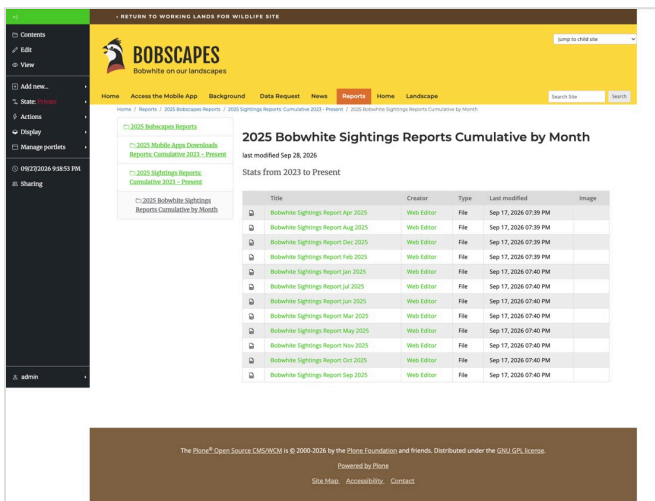
LIVE (dev 1440)



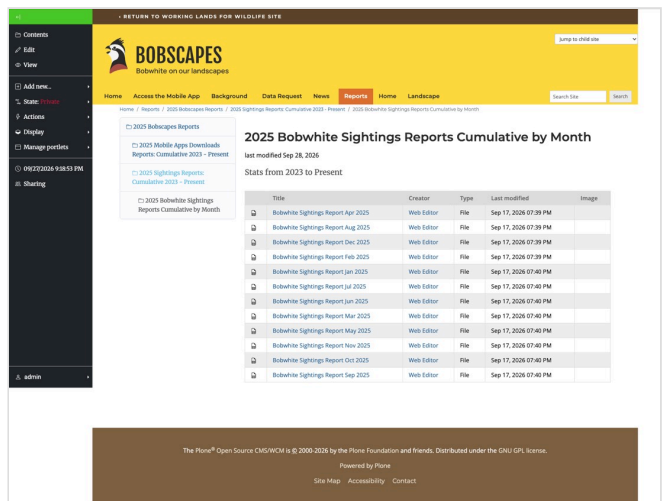
working-lands-for-wildlife home — BEFORE



AFTER — listing links blue; nav, pagination pill and footer unchanged



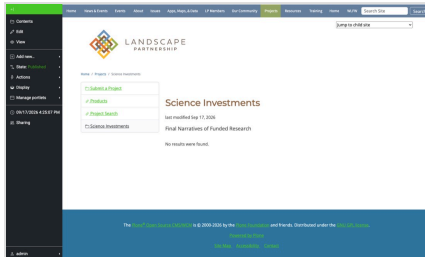
bobscapes tabular view — BEFORE (green titles and author links)



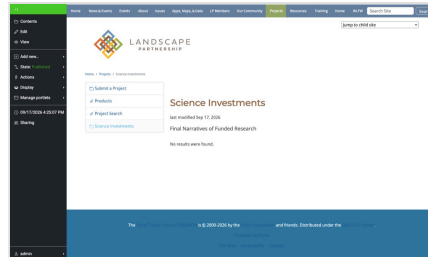
AFTER

## 4. Side effect found and handled — the stock footer band

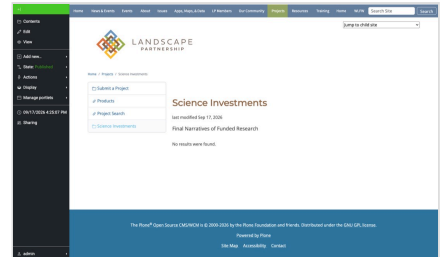
Every local sub-site still renders Plone's **stock footer** ("The Plone® Open Source CMS/WCM ... Powered by Plone · Site Map · Accessibility · Contact") — none of the live LP footers has been replicated yet (chrome, replication-plan scope). Each theme paints that band with a dark brand colour. Eleven themes also set an explicit footer link colour (white/cream), so they were unaffected; **lp-parent-site, anchor, aquatics and gis-planning** do not, so their footer links went from lime green on dark to #205c90 on dark — unreadable (middle capture below). The shared guard in `_base.scss` makes stock-footer links inherit the footer text colour with a faint underline; theme-set footer colours still win. Measured after: parent/anchor white, aquatics #dee2e6, gis-planning its themed #b7ccda, the eleven themed sites unchanged.



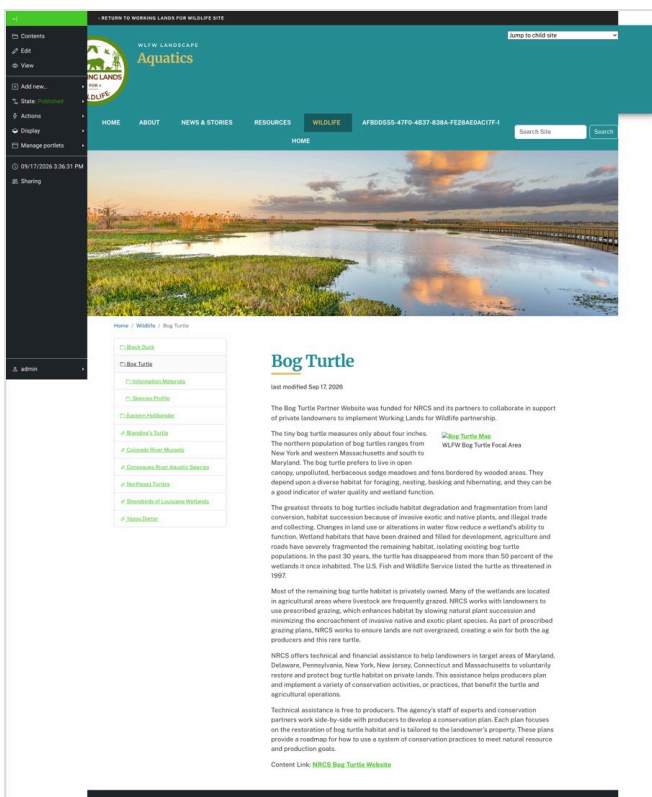
lp-parent — BEFORE (green links everywhere)



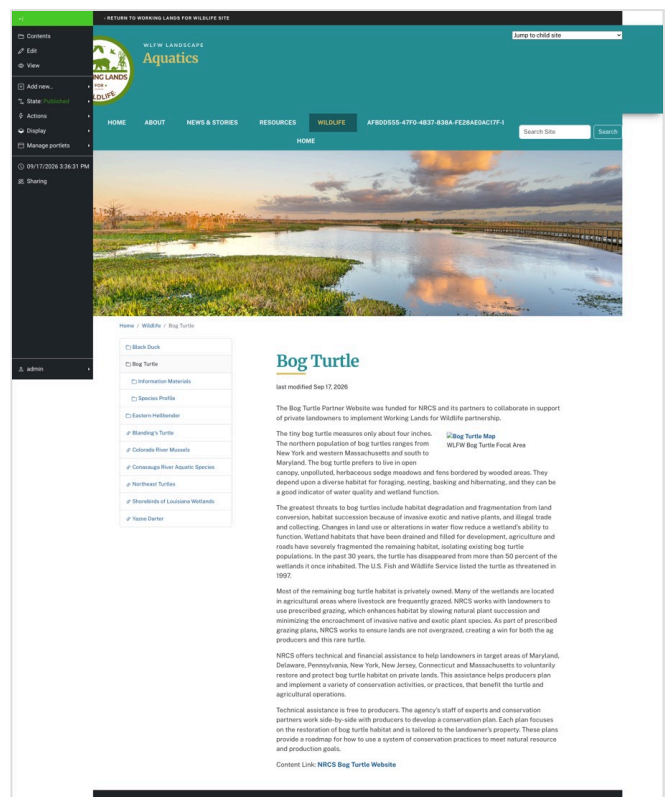
after \$link-color only — footer links vanish into the band



AFTER with the footer guard



aquatics bog turtle — BEFORE



AFTER

## 5. Left as-is / follow-ups

1. **Footers are still the stock Plone footer on all 15 sub-sites** — live parent footer is a transparent LP block with #205c90 links, sub-site footers are custom brown/blue bands with white links and logos. Replication-plan work; the guard above is a stopgap and says so in its comment.
2. **\$primary stays lime green**. It colours the published-state badge, `.btn-primary` (e.g. Barceloneta's "Download" button, pagination's active page) and focus rings. Live buttons are orange/blue per context; that is a separate decision (Bootstrap button theming), not a link issue.
3. The-literature-gateway keeps its own `#content a:link` (yellow on its dark layout) and anchor keeps its explicit `#content a` rule — both now redundant with Layer 1 for the colour but harmless; a later cleanup pass can drop the duplicates.
4. Visited links: live keeps them #205c90 (ploneCustom override); Bootstrap has no separate visited colour, so parity is automatic.